

FESTIVE MENU · 6–15 NOVEMBER 2026

Diwali 2026 in Edinburgh

A Vegetarian Diwali Menu, Festive Thali and Dinner at Kalpna

£20	£30	8 NOV
DIWALI THALI · PER PERSON	SET COURSE FOR TWO	DIWALI DAY · BOOK EARLY

Kalpna

2–3 St Patrick Square, Newington, Edinburgh · 0131 667 9890 · Vegetarian since 1975

Diwali 2026 is almost here, and if you're wondering **where to celebrate Diwali in Edinburgh** this year, the answer might be closer than you think. **Kalpna**, the long-standing **vegetarian restaurant in Edinburgh** at 2–3 St Patrick Square in Newington, is serving a special Diwali menu from **Friday 6th to Sunday 15th November 2026**.

For many families, Diwali (or Deepavali) is as much about the food as the lights. Diyas glow in the window, rangoli brightens the doorstep, and the dinner table fills with dishes that only come out once a year. Kalpna's festive menu brings that same feeling to a relaxed Diwali dinner in the heart of the Southside.

When Is Diwali 2026 in the UK?

The main day of Diwali 2026 in the UK is **Sunday 8th November**, when families perform Lakshmi Puja in the evening. The five-day festival starts with Dhanteras on Friday 6th November and closes with Bhai Dooj, the day that celebrates the bond between brothers and sisters.

FRI 6 NOV	SUN 8 NOV	SUN 15 NOV
Dhanteras Kalpna's Diwali menu begins	**Diwali Day** Lakshmi Puja in the evening	**Menu ends** Last Diwali dinner

That gives you two full weekends to book a Diwali dinner, whether you want to eat out on Diwali night or plan a get-together with friends later in the week.



A shared Kalpna table: thali dishes passed hand to hand, the Diwali way.

A Diwali Menu Inspired by Festive Food from Across India

Kalpna has been serving **Indian vegetarian food in Edinburgh since 1975**, and Diwali has always been one of the busiest and happiest weeks of its year. This year's Diwali special menu brings together festive food from both North and South India: a rich makhani gravy, coconut-based avial from Kerala, tangy Indian street food in the form of chaat, and the classic Diwali dessert of jalebi with rabri.

WELCOME DRINK	**"Diwali Surprise"** A surprise to start the evening. The recipe is a secret until you arrive.
STARTERS	**Beetroot Tikki** Delicately spiced with chilli and cream and served with traditional chutneys. The beetroot gives it a deep festive colour and a natural sweetness. **Patta Gobi Chaat** Crispy leaves with tamarind, fresh herbs and chatpatta spices. A crunchy nod to Indian street food.
MAIN COURSE	**Mewa Mozzarella Kofta in Makhani Gravy** Mewa means dried fruits and nuts, a staple of special food for Diwali. These koftas are filled with fresh mozzarella, nuts and dried fruits, then finished in a smooth makhani sauce. **Garden Avial** Seasonal vegetables cooked with coconut, curry leaves and South Indian spices. In Kerala, avial is a fixture at every celebration feast. **Lassoni Dal** Slow-cooked lentils with roasted garlic and a traditional tempering. Warm and comforting on a cold November night. **Basmati Rice** Steamed aged basmati to go with the gravy and dal.
DESSERT	**Jalebi with Rabri** Crisp golden jalebi with cool, creamy rabri. Few Diwali sweets are loved quite as much.
PALATE REFRESHER	**Paan Kulfi** A bite-size Paan Kulfi, a traditional way to round off a festive Indian meal.
A DIWALI GIFT	**A small Diwali gesture** Every guest who orders from the festive menu leaves with a small Diwali gesture from the team, keeping alive the tradition of sharing gifts and sweets.

Diwali Thali or Set Menu: Two Ways to Enjoy Your Diwali Dinner

The Diwali set menu comes in two simple options.

£20

DIWALI THALI · PER PERSON

The full festive menu served together on one plate, the traditional way. A thali lets you move between sweet, sour, spicy and creamy in every bite, and it's the easiest way to taste everything at once.

£30

SET COURSE FOR TWO

The same dishes served course by course for two people to share. It works well for couples, close friends, or anyone looking for a festive date night in Edinburgh.

If you're new to thalis, Kalpna's guide to the Indian thali explains how to enjoy one. Individual dish prices are available in the restaurant if you'd like to order something on its own.

The Diwali Food Traditions Behind the Menu

Most dishes on a Diwali dinner menu carry a meaning beyond taste.

1. **Sweets for a sweet year ahead**
   Sharing Diwali sweets is a way of wishing others prosperity, which is why the menu ends with two sweet courses.

2. **Dried fruits and nuts for abundance**
   Almonds, cashews and raisins appear in Diwali gift boxes and festive cooking alike, and the mewa kofta carries that tradition into the main course.

3. **Many dishes, one plate**
   The Diwali thali mirrors the way families lay out several dishes together during the festival, so everyone gets a taste of everything.

4. **A season of celebration**
   Diwali follows soon after Navratri and Dussehra, so for many families October and November feel like one long festive season. To see how the wider city marks the occasion, read Kalpna's guide on how to celebrate Diwali in Edinburgh.

Tips for Booking a Diwali Dinner in Edinburgh

- **Book early.** The Diwali menu runs for just ten days, and Diwali weekend fills up fast.
- **Mention dietary needs.** The festive dishes contain dairy (cream, mozzarella, rabri and kulfi), nuts and garlic. Let the team know about any allergies when you book.
- **Bring the family.** A Diwali party menu like this one suits every age, from crunchy chaat to sweet jalebi.
- **Come hungry.** A welcome drink, two starters, four main dishes, dessert and a palate refresher make for a proper Diwali feast.

Why Choose Kalpna for Your Diwali Celebration in Edinburgh

If you're searching for the **best Indian restaurant in Edinburgh for Diwali**, a few things make Kalpna stand out.

- **A fully vegetarian kitchen.** Every dish is vegetarian, so there's no need to double-check the menu.
- **Five decades of heritage.** Kalpna has been part of Edinburgh's Indian food scene since 1975.
- **North and South Indian food.** Alongside the festive menu, the regular menu includes dosas, thalis and curries from across India.
- **Easy to reach.** St Patrick Square is a short walk from the University of Edinburgh, the Southside and the Old Town.

Diwali Menu FAQs

Q. When is Kalpna's Diwali menu available?
From Friday 6th to Sunday 15th November 2026, including Diwali day on Sunday 8th November.

Q. How much is the Diwali thali?
£20 per person. The Set Course for two is £30.

Q. Is the Diwali menu vegetarian?
Yes, every dish is vegetarian.

Q. Is it vegan?
Not as served, since it contains dairy. The regular menu has vegan-marked dishes the team can point you to.

Q. Do I need to book?
Booking is strongly recommended, especially for Diwali weekend and larger groups.

Book Your Diwali Table at Kalpna

Kalpna's Diwali festive menu runs from 6th to 15th November 2026, with the Diwali thali at £20 per person and the set course for two at £30. Book your Diwali dinner in Edinburgh online, or call **0131 667 9890**.

Happy Diwali from everyone at Kalpna. Here's to a festival full of light, family and good food.